

INTALKWITH

- **What are the current Government policies that can be defined as investor-friendly?**

The State Government is trying its best to attract investments in the state, for which we are trying to get a rebate on CST (Central Sales Tax). We are also trying to see that the units can be established at pithead. The government would also be announcing the Rehabilitation and Resettlement (R&R) policy within a month's time, which would make the process of land acquisition faster and easier. This would ensure a benchmark price for the land and introducing seller as a share holder of the new industry, so that both the buyer and the seller can benefit from this. The Linkage policy would reduce the time required for processing of lease.

- **Which are the key sectors in which the Government is focussing right now? What are the steps being taken in this regard?**

The key sectors where the Government is focussing right now are steel, mining, power and agriculture. Many major power plants are being set up in the state, which would enable surplus power generation in the state within a time span of three years. In agricultural sector, the concept of contract farming is being introduced, so that farmers could get financial and technical support and even in case of excess production, the farmer gets back his invested amount. Support price is being provided on lac farming, as the state is the leading producer of lac in the country. Government has plan to invite private investors in technical & management education field so that the youth of the state would have better job opportunities.

- **Tribal welfare being one of the key concerns of the state, what measures have been taken in this regard in the past one year?**

The Government is working on educating primitive tribes. About 12 schools have been opened up in the state, which are fully sponsored by the State Government. These schools are equipped with all facilities and education is totally free. These schools provide education up to 10th standard. These schools would be run by NGOs and the Government would constantly monitor the progress being made. Out of the 212 blocks in the state, 112 blocks can be termed as scheduled blocks. The Government is providing loans and grants to promote self-employment. The loan is being provided for sectors like animal husbandry, agriculture, etc. The Government has a vision of providing hundred percent free educations to the girls upto 10th standard, free schooling up to 10th class in Kasturba Avashiya Balika Vidyalyas also.

Over 32 per cent of the area of the state is forested, where primitive tribes live. They pick up Sal seeds and sell them, which provides them with employment for a period of three months. Picking up of these seeds was earlier illegal, but now, the Government has removed the ban.

Silk cocoon production training centres have been set up in Dumka, Kathikund, etc, where tribals are imparted with free-of-cost training and provided with financial aid to set up their own units.

- **How is state gearing up for the forthcoming National Games?**

We are two months behind schedule, but we have asked the contractors to increase manpower for faster completion of work. We are targeting the last week of February as our completion time and after that it depends on the Indian Olympic Association. They will give us dates to host the games.

- **Jharkhand is sometimes perceived to be a disturbed state by outsiders. How would you ensure the safety & security of tourists and investors?**

We do have Naxal affected areas, but we are taking necessary

measures to fight it out. The para-military forces are being provided with up-graded training skills to fight against naxals. Since the inter-state border line does not have any special manual that provides a provision for two states to fight against them jointly, we have requested the Union Home minister to formulate an act in this regard.

- **Addressing of which one issue, would you say, will change the future of Jharkhand?**

We are facing a major problem of unemployment. A major part of our population, about 54 per cent, is below the poverty line. Around 70 per cent of the BPL population lives in villages. Special schemes are being planned to help this situation. More than 30,000 Self-Help Groups (SHGs) have been formed, which is helping in developing self-employment opportunities. The government has constituted integrated tribal development agency and in fifth schedule area of the state, to benefit the local tribal communities and special attention being focused on them."

Shri Madhu Koda
Hon'ble Chief Minister
of Jharkhand

